

say the entrepreneurs did a good job of convincing me to invest. There were all kinds of ideas on which the start-ups were founded, many of which were actually quite absurd. Some of them were ahead of their time and, launched a few years later, would perhaps have done much better.

Of course, I was not alone. To use a pun, I was in good company. I was hoping that even if two of them did well, I would still be able to at least double my overall investment. Over the next years, the majority of them turned out to be duds. I managed to exit a couple of them at a modest profit. But on the whole my start-up portfolio was a disaster.

Nevertheless, it was a good experience in terms of understanding some of the business models and the aspiring businessmen.